The Bilal Morning

Saturday, 17 October 2026 LIVE EDITION 12 stories · 14 sources

1 source articles could not be read today; those stories show headlines and links only.

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1. SpaceX Crew-12 astronauts returned after eight months in orbit and reflected on planetary preservation.
2. The James Webb Space Telescope revealed unique 3D atmospheric features of the exoplanet WASP-17b.
3. Astronomers discovered a twisting radio structure known as the Treble Clef in a galaxy collision.

Crew-12 Astronauts Reflect on Fragile Earth After Eight Months in Orbit

Returning from the International Space Station, SpaceX Crew-12 astronauts shared how seeing Earth from space altered their view of humanity and planetary preservation.

- The international Crew-12 team returned to Earth following an extended mission at the space station. [space.com]

  > “Crew-12 spent nearly eight months aboard the ISS, finally returning to Earth on Oct. 8.”

- Mission commander Jessica Meir noted that observing Earth's delicate atmosphere underscored the urgent need to safeguard the planet. [space.com]

  > “You see this very thin, tenuous band of an atmosphere, and you know that that is all that is supporting life”

- Cosmonaut Andrey Fedyaev explained that the cooperative, borderless life of space station crewmembers serves as a model for humanity. [space.com]

  > “the life of crewmembers on board the space station is the best example of how people need to live on Earth”

- Crew-12 member Sophie Adenot made history during the mission with a milestone spacewalk. [space.com]

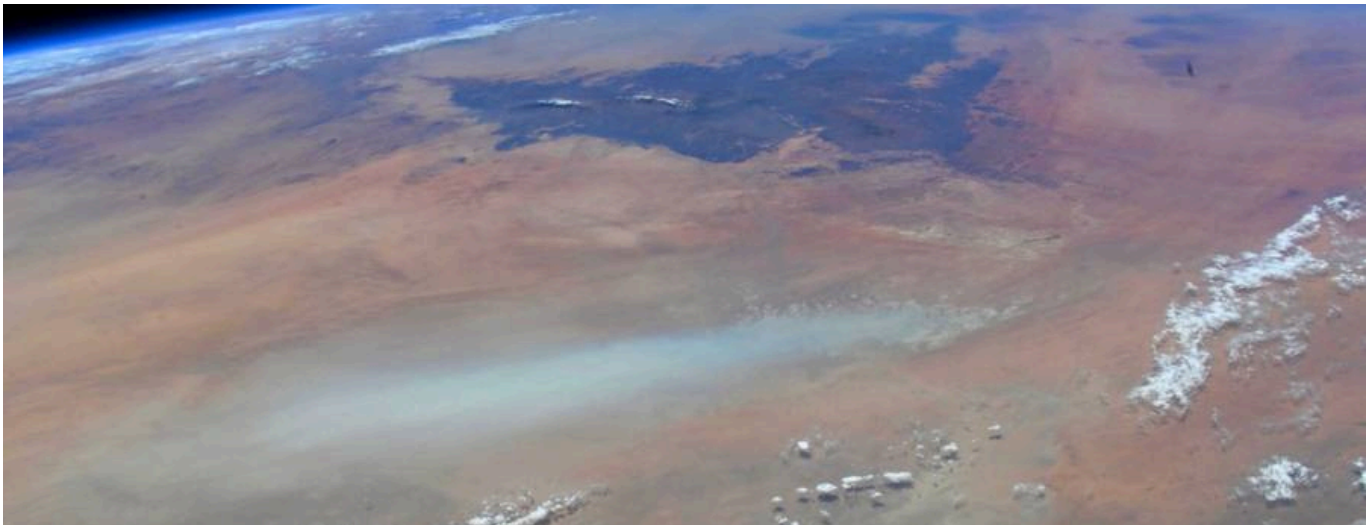
  > “Adenot became the first French woman ever to perform a spacewalk”

In the image: A high-altitude orbital view reveals reddish desert terrain and an elongated pale dust or haze plume beneath the blue curve of Earth's atmosphere.

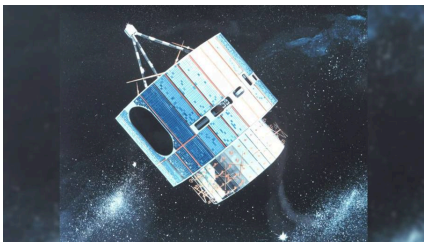
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SPACE EXPLORATION



NASA Launches First GOES Weather Satellite

On October 16, 1975, NASA launched GOES-A, marking the beginning of a revolutionary weather satellite fleet.

- NASA launched the first operational GOES weather satellite on October 16, 1975. [space.com]

  > "On Oct. 16, 1975, NASA launched the first operational GOES satellite!"

- The satellite was jointly operated with NOAA and launched on a Delta rocket from Cape Canaveral. [space.com]

  > "GOES-A was the first in a series of weather satellites that NASA jointly operated with the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration"

- GOES-1 provided forecasters with their earliest near-real time atmospheric observations from a fixed position. [space.com]

  > "gave forecasters their first near-real time look at atmospheric conditions from a fixed location"

In the image: An artistic illustration of the GOES satellite orbiting in space with starry backgrounds.

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TWA Hotel Hosts Three-Day Mission: 60s Space Age Celebration

New York's TWA Hotel will host the Mission: 60s event, bridging the historic Apollo era with modern space exploration through panels, tours, and galas.

- The TWA Hotel in New York is hosting a three-day celebration called Mission: 60s from October 23 to October 25 to bridge the Apollo and Artemis eras. [space.com]

  > "The three-day celebration, from Oct. 23 to Oct. 25, will bridge the Apollo and Artemis eras."

- The event is organized by Luna Replicas and Space for Humanity to connect the history of reaching the moon with the current space race. [space.com]

  > "Organized by Luna Replicas, a company specializing in vintage space gear, and Space for Humanity, a nonprofit that underwrites spaceflight experiences"

- Activities kick off on Friday with a guided tour of the 1964 World's Fair site in Flushing Meadows, featuring historic rockets and the Unisphere. [space.com]

  > "On Friday (Oct. 23), Mission: 60s begins with a guided tour of the 1964 World's Fair site in Flushing Meadows."

- The weekend features panel discussions with notable speakers including Apollo flight director Gerry Griffin, former astronauts, and Star Trek actors. [space.com]

  > "Featured speakers and moderators include Apollo flight director Gerry Griffin, TIME Magazine science editor Jeffrey Kluger, former NASA astronauts Nicole Stott and Ron Garan, "Star Trek" actor Bob Picardo and researcher Frank White."

In the image: A person dressed in a vintage Apollo spacesuit and sunglasses stands outdoors near the TWA Hotel structure.

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Blue Origin Upgrades Infrastructure for New Glenn Rocket to Compete with SpaceX

Blue Origin is investing heavily in new launch and production facilities to support multiple weekly flights of its New Glenn rocket by the end of the decade.

- Blue Origin aims to fly its New Glenn rocket multiple times per week by the end of the decade to compete with SpaceX. [thenews.com.pk]

  > “Blue Origin is aiming to fly its New Glenn heavy-lift rocket multiple times per week by the end of the decade.”

- The company has spent over $3 billion on its Florida production and integration facilities. [thenews.com.pk]

  > “Blue Origin has already spent over $3 billion on its Florida production and integration facilities, spanning 31 acres with approximately 5000 workers.”

- An additional $330 million expansion is underway and scheduled for completion by summer 2027. [thenews.com.pk]

  > “targeted an additional $330 million expansion which is underway and the facility is targeted for completion by summer 2027”

- A New Glenn rocket exploded during a test in May, causing severe pad damage. [thenews.com.pk]

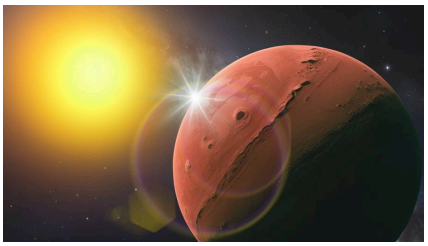
  > “In May, a 322-foot New Glenn rocket exploded on the company’s sole active Florida pad during a test”

In the image: The image shows an overhead view of a large New Glenn rocket resting horizontally on a transport vehicle at the launch facility.

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thenews.com.pk

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JWST Reveals Unique 3D Atmospheric Features of Exoplanet WASP-17b

Astronomers used the James Webb Space Telescope and a novel technique to map the complex, ring-like atmosphere of the scorching exoplanet WASP-17b.

- Astronomers utilized the James Webb Space Telescope to study the atmosphere of the exoplanet WASP-17b. [space.com]

  > "Using data from the James Webb Space Telescope (JWST), astronomers have unraveled some of the atmospheric secrets of a bizarre, blisteringly hot world"

- WASP-17b has a very low density comparable to a marshmallow and is roughly twice the width of Jupiter. [space.com]

  > "The exoplanet has a mass around 0.8 times that of Jupiter, but it is around twice as wide as the solar system's largest planet"

- Researchers applied a new technique called transmission strings to map the contours of the atmosphere. [space.com]

  > "Using a new technique called transmission strings, a team of scientists mapped the contours of the atmosphere of WASP-17b."

- WASP-17b is tidally locked, meaning one side of the planet permanently faces its parent star. [space.com]

  > "WASP-17b is so close to its parent star that it is tidally locked, meaning one side permanently faces the star"

In the image: The image provides an artistic illustration of a red, cratered exoplanet illuminated by a bright star with a lens flare effect, showcasing an environment not detailed in the text.

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space.com

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Astronomers Discover 'Treble Clef' Radio Structure in Galaxy Collision

Using advanced radio telescopes, astronomers have revealed a twisting, Phoenix-like radio structure known as the Treble Clef hidden inside a massive galaxy cluster collision 1.6 billion light-years away.

- Astronomers discovered a winding radio structure resembling a treble clef inside a massive galaxy cluster collision. [mashable.com]

  > "The space object loops and curls in thin strands, earning its nickname, the Treble Clef."

- The object is classified as a radio phoenix, which is a cloud of faded particles brought back to life. [mashable.com]

  > "It's what researchers refer to as a "radio phoenix," a cloud of faded particles brought back to life."

- Data from NASA's Chandra X-ray Observatory and the German eROSITA space telescope helped determine the cluster's distance, temperature, and mass. [mashable.com]

  > "That signal let the researchers pin down the cluster's distance — about 1.6 billion light-years away — temperature, and mass for the first time"

- The galaxy cluster involved in the merger weighs roughly 600 trillion times

more than our sun.

[mashable.com]

> “The cluster weighs about 600 trillion times as much as our sun.”

In the image: The image visually displays the intricate pink, filamentary 'Treble Clef' structure entangled within a broader blue diffuse radio glow against a starfield background.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

mashable.com

You engaged with 12 of 20 Astronomy and astrophysics stories you saw

Astronomers Discover the First Real Green Star After Ingesting Planet Debris

Researchers found that a dense white dwarf star glows in a rare chartreuse green after swallowing rocky material from its planetary system.

- Astronomers discovered the first real green star, identified as white dwarf WD J1330+6435 located about 280 light-years away.

  [emirates247.com]

  > “Astronomers discover the first real green star, a white dwarf 280 light-years away glowing after ingesting rocky planetary debris”

- The white dwarf's immense atmospheric density alters sodium atomic energy levels, causing it to absorb yellow, orange, and red wavelengths and emit a green glow.

  [gizmodo.com][emirates247.com]

  > “the density is so high that the sodium atoms are constantly being bombarded by surrounding helium atoms, which alters the sodium atomic energy levels”

- Lead author Mark Hollands noted that traces of sodium absorb the orange spectrum, leaving behind a ghostly green glow resembling science fiction. [gizmodo.com]

  > “The traces of sodium in the atmosphere of this white dwarf absorb the orange part of the spectrum, leaving behind a ghostly green glow”

- Researchers also identified a salmon pink white dwarf named WD J1011+2845, where carbon emerged from its deep interior rather than from outside debris.

  [emirates247.com]

  > “Rather than something hitting the star, in this case the carbon comes out from its deep interior”

In the image: An artist's impression of the white dwarf star WD J1330+6435 surrounded by an accretion disk and rocky planetary debris.

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gizmodo.com · emirates247.com · moneycontrol.com

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How to get the most out of stargazing apps

Discover how to effectively use stargazing apps to identify stars, find dark sky sites, and plan your next skywatching adventure.

- Stargazing apps typically require a mobile or Wi-Fi signal with data for optimal use, although some support offline functionality. [space.com]

  > “you'll typically need a mobile or Wi-Fi signal with data to make the most of these apps.”

- Apps like Sky Tonight allow users to easily identify stars, planets, and constellations simply by pointing their phone's camera at them. [space.com]

  > “Launch the app, grant it camera access and turn it towards the object you want to identify.”

- Sky Walk 2 enables users to input GPS coordinates and match past photographs to the exact night sky view of that time. [space.com]

  > “you can input GPS co-ordinates and Sky Walk 2 will show you the view from that location.”

- Light pollution maps help users locate nearby areas with darker skies by grading light pollution levels on the Bortle scale. [space.com]

  > “will show you the light pollution levels locally and globally, estimated on the Bortle scale.”

- If a stargazing app is malfunctioning, users can try calibrating their phone's compass by moving the device in a figure eight motion. [space.com]

  > “Swoop your phone in a figure eight motion. This can help calibrate your phone's compass.”

In the image: A hand holding a smartphone displaying a stargazing app interface directed towards the night sky.

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space.com

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CRICKET

Jasprit Bumrah Returns to India's Test Squad for New Zealand Series

Jasprit Bumrah returns to India's test squad, and Rishabh Pant is named subject to fitness clearance for the upcoming series.

- Jasprit Bumrah has returned to India's test cricket squad for the upcoming series in New Zealand. [home.nzcity.co.nz]

  > “Pace spearhead Jasprit Bumrah is back in India's test cricket squad”

- Wicketkeeper Rishabh Pant has been included in the squad subject to receiving fitness clearance.

  [home.nzcity.co.nz]

  > “wicketkeeper Rishabh Pant has been named subject to fitness clearance for next month's two-match series”

- Bumrah has not played in a test match since November of the previous year.

  [home.nzcity.co.nz]

  > “Bumrah hasn't played a test since November last year”

- Pant was previously ruled out of the India A matches due to a side strain.

  [home.nzcity.co.nz]

  > “Pant was recently ruled out of the first two India A four-day matches against New Zealand A with a side strain”

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home.nzcity.co.nz

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Bangladesh v Zimbabwe - ODI tri-series scorecard

Latest scorecard from the one-day international tri-series match between Bangladesh and Zimbabwe in Abu Dhabi.

bbc.co.uk

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Faith and Family in Sompot Chidgasornpongse's 9 Temples to Heaven

A Thai family visits nine Buddhist temples in a single day, racing against time to extend an elderly mother's life through merit-making and prayer.

- The frantic journey is prompted by a premonition from Sakol's employer regarding his mother's health. [hyperallergic.com]

  > “The trip is sparked by a premonition from Sakol’s employer — who has a history with prescient visions — that requires him to finish this auspicious number of visits”

- The movie explores the coexistence of spiritual traditions and mundane capitalist life in modern Thailand. [hyperallergic.com]

  > “9 Temples to Heaven appears to matter-of-factly catalog how Buddhism functions in Thailand amid capitalism, patriarchy, and other mundane aspects of daily life.”

- Despite the hopeful pilgrimage, the film's opening scene reveals a funeral preparation for the mother. [hyperallergic.com]

  > “They’re preparing for a funeral.”

In the image: The image shows family members kneeling respectfully during a temple ritual, bringing a visual sense of devotion that complements the film's premise.

✓ 3 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

hyperallergic.com

Exploring: a Religion story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more



Nepal's Flood Exposes Risks of Resettling Disaster Survivors

Tens of thousands of displaced people in Nepal facing new dangers in vulnerable temporary settlements.

- Chheku Lama attempted to warn others to flee uphill when the flood arrived, though the group following him unfortunately did not survive. [reporterherald.com]

  > "When the flood came, Chheku Lama ran uphill, shouting for people to flee. A group followed him, but none survived"

- The temporary settlement in Khalte village was situated dangerously along the Trishuli River in a narrow valley following the 2015 earthquake. [reporterherald.com]

  > "homes clustered along the Trishuli River in a narrow valley"

- The destructive flash flood surged through the area on August 26, wiping out the village and leaving residents with severely limited escape routes. [reporterherald.com]

  > "When the floodwaters surged through on Aug. 26, residents had few routes to escape."

- Residents report that at least 375 people went missing during the disaster in the village. [reporterherald.com]

  > "At least 375 people were reported missing, according to residents."

- Disaster survivors emphasize that the government needs to transition from temporary shelters to providing safe, permanent housing. [reporterherald.com]

  > "Survivors say the government must go beyond emergency relief and temporary shelter to provide safe, permanent places where displaced people can rebuild their lives."

In the image: The image displays close-up portraits of six specific survivors—Birbal Tamang, Nima Choying Tamang, Kancha Ghale, Norchi Ghale, Buddha Tamang, and Chheku Lama—putting human faces to the tragedy of those affected by both the 2015 earthquake and the August flash floods.

✓ 5 of 5 claims verified against sources · 1 source

reporterherald.com

Exploring: a Disaster and accidents story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more

You're caught up.

That's today's paper. Your next edition arrives tomorrow morning.